

DO

STATUES PERFORM MIRACLES?

Catholic Christians sometimes report that statues of the Virgin Mary or other saints weep real tears. In 1995, statues of the Hindu god Ganesh, in India, were said to be swallowing milk. Worshipers saw it as a miracle. However, these phenomena can often be explained by physical causes. In the case of Ganesh, the milk was simply being absorbed by capillarity (a process by which liquid rises spontaneously in porous materials) into the stone.

WHAT

ABOUT DISASTER VICTIMS?

In 1985, an earthquake in Mexico City killed more than 10,000 people. Seven days later, 22 newborn babies (known as the "Miracle Babies") were pulled from the rubble alive. Similarly, one victim of the devastating Haiti earthquake in 2010 survived for 28 days before being rescued. To the survivors of such disasters, their families, and rescuers, it is a miracle. In reality, they have just been luckier than all of the others who lost their lives.

WOULD

IT TAKE A MIRACLE TO WIN THE LOTTERY?

No—someone has to win. But your chances of winning a major national or state lottery are in the millions, as much as 20 million to one in some cases. You are 45 times more likely to be killed by lightning. So, it would certainly seem like a miracle, wouldn't it? Sometimes, when special events happen to one person, they perceive it to be a miracle and forget that it happens to someone else every week. It is a miracle for them personally, but it is not a miracle in the grand scheme of things.

